

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

MONDAY, AUGUST 18, 2025

Boston prepares for sanctuary showdown

Senators back city as US demands Wu toss out policies and assist ICE's efforts

By Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

Prominent members of the state's congressional delegation are defending the city of Boston as it faces fresh demands to dismantle policies the Trump administration views as friendly to undocumented immigrants.

US Attorney General Pamela Bondi has mandated the city submit a plan by Tuesday for reversing practices and local rules that prompted the US Department of Justice to designate Boston as a "sanctuary jurisdiction."

Mayor Michelle Wu, a Democrat, said the city is crafting a response,

but accused Republican President Trump of bullying communities and breaking the law, a criticism echoed on Saturday by the state's two US senators and a member of the congressional delegation who represents parts of Boston.

"We know where this is coming from and we know why. Unlike the Trump administration, Boston follows the law and it's as simple as that," Wu said Friday night in East Boston, according to a recording of

her remarks provided by her staff.

Bondi outlined her demands to Wu and the leaders of other jurisdictions that the Trump administration believes are impeding his immigration enforcement efforts in letters dated Wednesday.

"This ends now," Bondi wrote, according to a copy of the letter shared with the Globe.

Senator Edward Markey, a Malden Democrat, accused Bondi

SANCTUARY, Page A7

Trump will meet with Zelensky, EU leaders

Macron vows 'united front' behind Ukraine's president

By Constant Méheut and Enjoli Liston
NEW YORK TIMES

European leaders said Sunday that they would join President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine when he meets with President Trump on Monday at the White House, as they strive to show solidarity against Russia and avoid being sidelined in peace talks.

"Our goal tomorrow is to present a united front between Europeans and Ukrainians," President Emmanuel Macron of France told reporters. "I don't believe Putin wants peace. I believe he wants Ukraine's capitulation."

Trump and two advisers spent Sunday trying to recast the lack of a cease-fire in the war in Ukraine as one step in a possibly slow march toward peace. It was a significant departure from the peace agreement that the president said he had wanted out of a meeting in Alaska with Russian President Vladimir Putin just 48 hours earlier.

Steve Witkoff, an envoy for Trump who had attended the meeting in Anchorage, said in a CNN interview Sunday that Putin had edged toward making some concessions in talks to end the war, including by agreeing to strong security protections, though not under NATO, that Trump had

UKRAINE, Page A4



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Michael Fiorentino (front right) prayed with his fellow congregants at the Second Congregational United Church of Christ in Beverly. At its peak, the church served 750 people. Today, it has 64 members.

A NEW MISSION

Area churches are turning their buildings into low-income housing



The Rev. Adam Isbitsky, pastor of Second Congregational Church.

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

BEVERLY

—On a recent weekday afternoon, the Rev. Adam Isbitsky walked through a sea of empty pews, the clack of his footsteps echoing off the high ceilings of the sanctuary at Second Congregational Church.

Not so long ago, he recalled, these pews would fill up every Sunday with hundreds of worshippers. Those days are gone. As the church's congregation has dwindled in recent years, those who remain made the difficult decision recently to dissolve this 300-year-old institution in favor of a new purpose: services for the homeless.

In a year or so, the congregation has plans to hand over the keys to the building to the homeless nonprofit Lifebridge North Shore, to be transformed into a resource center for the North Shore's growing homeless population.

The decision to close the church was difficult and painful, said Isbitsky, whom the congregation hired last year to be its "legacy pastor," charged with guiding the institution through its dissolution and ensuring an enduring legacy. Deciding what to do with the property was much simpler.

"It is impossible to ignore how difficult it has become to

CHURCH HOUSING, Page A10

BPS bilingual programs fall short of need

Even planned expansion won't keep pace with rise in schools' English learners

By Maria Probert
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Guatemalan-native Camila Ordoñez entered Boston Public Schools in 2021 at age 8, she began attending Paul A. Dever Elementary. But three months later, the district contacted her mother and said the girl's lack of English made the school a wrong fit.

The district then moved Camila to Blackstone Elementary, where the classes are mostly taught in English as well, but she did get some Spanish language support. Her mother, Herminia Ordoñez, said the unexpected transition has been difficult on the family, and she didn't realize so many BPS schools lack bilingual options.

"It would be good if all schools had some sort of bilingual program, and teachers prepared to teach the home languages," Ordoñez said in Spanish.

BPS is slowly rolling out an expansion to its multilingual and bilingual program, but it hasn't been enough to keep up with the district's growing immigrant population. About a third of BPS's

BILINGUAL, Page A7

~33%
of BPS's
48,000
students are
English
learners.

Free tuition can expand students' horizons

State's community college programs boost enrollment, retention, hopes

By Mara Kardas-Nelson and Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

Until recently, Michael Hannigan figured he'd never go back to school.

When he was in his late 20s, he'd enrolled in community college to study farming, an interest he developed when he worked on tobacco farms growing up in Western Massachusetts. Hannigan was the first in his family to attend college. To support himself, he worked as a janitor at University of Massachusetts Amherst.

Balancing full-time work and school was difficult. After a semester, he dropped out, owing more than \$2,000 in unpaid fees. It took years working as a dishwasher and a janitor to pay it off.

"Whenever I thought about going back to school I knew that if, for some reason, I got overwhelmed with work and couldn't go to school, I'd accrue that debt," Hannigan, 43, said. "It's one of the things that dissuaded me from going to school again."

Hannigan is now president of the Greenfield Community College student senate, president of the college's permaculture club, and two classes short of graduating with a degree in farm and

COMMUNITY COLLEGE, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Pedro Rentas turned a two-year degree into a branch manager's job at Reading Cooperative Bank in Lawrence.



The warm has turned

Monday: Refreshing, sun late. High 68-73, low 55-60.
Tuesday: Sunny and pleasant. High 70-75, low 58-63.
Sunrise: 5:55. Sunset: 7:41.
Weather and comics, **D4-5**.

Obituaries, **C9**.
VOL. 308, NO. 49
*
Suggested retail price
\$4.00



0 947725 4

Israeli protesters, in one of the largest series of demonstrations against the war in Gaza, shut down roads and targeted officials' homes as they demanded the release of hostages and the shelving of military plans to take over Gaza City. **A3**.

Boston has recorded 24 homicides this year, tying the number in all of 2024, but the rates of most other crimes continue to fall. **B1**.

A developer seeks to build a massive commercial and residential project in Dedham that could be more than twice the size of the town's Legacy Place shopping center. **D1**.

For breaking news, updated stories, and more, visit our website:

BostonGlobe.com